COMPANY CONFIDENTIAL

November 18, 1960

Memorandum to: Mr. N. P. Edwards

SUBJECT: Status of HARVEST and FARMBOY

In regard to our "viewing with alarm" the status of these projects, I have just picked up the following information in Poughkeepsie:

(1) The STRETCH machine is now working quite well on long runs sometimes of an half hour or more in length. The I/O equipment is slowly being attached. The online printer is working most of the time.

(2) The HARVEST system has been making very fast progress in the past month. It is now streaming in two modes. Both the high speed memory and the TRACTOR tapes have been working recently. The engineers feel that the progress is "unnatural" and they expect to come to a serious road-block shortly.

(3) The delivery date of HARVEST is still unknown. A meeting was held in White Plains, Friday, November 17, 1960, to discuss this serious situation the Customer. T. R. Horton, C. R. Green and Mike Reilly of FSD were present. Perhaps you would want to talk to one of them to find out what was decided. The Customer will be informed of the status at a meeting Tuesday, November 29, 1960.

(4) The basic FARMBOY programming system has been able to make fair progress by using the STRETCH simulator on the 709. One big Customer problem centers around the so-called "Alpha language" processor. This is an involved subject which I won't go into here. Suffice it to say that the Customer is divided within his own ranks concerning it.

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(5) The STRETCH-HARVEST programming group (including FARMBOY) has just been transferred to the management of Al Harmon (DP Applied Programming--White Plains). This should cause no immediate changes in the programs, but could result in a change of emphasis toward commercial applications later.

The situation on these projects is serious, but Marketing now seems to be taking an active hand in them. I feel that this Department need not take any preemptive action at the moment.

H. G. Kolsky
Senior Engineer

HGK/bh